

ML4NLP1 - Intro Tutorial

Fall Semester 2026

E-mail @ TAs
Reach out through OLAT!

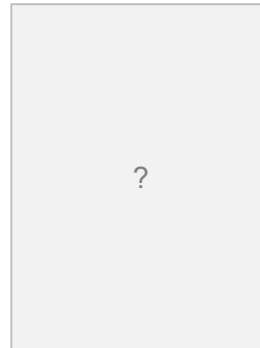
When, Where, Who

Every Monday at 16:15, RAK-E-8. After the lecture, in the same room. 30-45 mins

TA team:



Alina Ponomareva
MSc Student
Informatics, UZH
took ML4NLP1 and ML4NLP2



Mystery Personnel
to be hired (hopefully)

Special thanks to the previous members of the teaching teams:

They have studied and carefully created part of the materials we teach:

- Dr. Tannon Kew
- Shivam Adarsh
- Patrick Haller
- Janis Goldzycher
- Ahmet Yavuz Uluslu
- Phillip Ströbel
- Andrianos Michail
- Michelle Wastl
- Konstantinos Kalyfommatos

What

We bring you on track with modern practical Natural Language Processing. You can see these tutorials content as a hands on experience with:

- Building your own NLP solutions (without always relying on APIs!)
- Reading and understanding weak points of existing NLP solutions.
- Preparation for NLP focused ML Engineer / Data Scientist job assessments



Footnotes: 1. Content of the tutorial MIGHT be recorded. 2. Attendance is not mandatory, but it is wise to hear the clues :D

How

Five Practical Coding Assignments (Done in Teams of 3) - Introduced biweekly

Exercise 1:

Released: Monday September 28th at 15:00
Submission Deadline: Sunday 11th of October at 23:59
Anonymous Peer Review Starts: Monday 12th of October at 20:00
Anonymous Peer Review Deadline: Monday 19th of October at 23:59
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– Other Practical Content (Can be part of the final exam)

We aim to cover a broad range of topics:

- NLP through classic ML methods
- Building your own Neural Networks in PyTorch
- Word Embeddings, Representation Learning, Embedding (Retrieval) models
- Understanding, prompting and fine-tuning Large (Small) Language Models
- Topic and Neural Topic Modelling

Submitting on OLAT

- **Every member of the team submits the same file on OLAT.** This is what the peer review is assigned from.
- **Do not write your names or your team name in the notebook:** submissions are reviewed anonymously.
- The upload closes at 23:59 sharp and **late submissions are not accepted**, so upload early and check that the file is really there.
- Each exercise appears in the OLAT menu at its release time. You will see it in the Exercises section.
- Subscribe to the Exercise forum (bell icon at the top right): corrections and updates to the assignments are announced there.
- Assignment questions go to the forum. Anything personal (problems in your team, illness, a failed upload) goes to E-mail @ TAs, before the deadline.

Anonymous Peer Review on OLAT

- After submitting the assignment, **each person must complete an anonymous peer review** by answering pre-determined questions for one assignment (therefore x3 peer reviews per team)
- Goal of the peer review is to have a guided process to help your peer improve their work and know how to do it better next time.
- The peer review includes a preliminary grade. Final grades are decided by Tutors and don't have to be at all related to the preliminary grade.
- If you do not submit your peer review, you receive a **0.25 point penalty** on the final grade of that exercise.

Forming Teams of 3 (mandatory)

Please speak with your classmates and form **TEAMS OF 3** that you will work together in all the assignments.

To form your teams, please **post the full names of all three members, exactly as they appear in OLAT, in this thread in the Exercise forum:** [link](#)

Team Forming Deadline: Friday 2nd of October 2026

How to access files from the tutorials

We put all the tutorial content within the [GitHub Repo](#). In the repo you can find:

- All the content taught within the tutorials (also last year's)
- The given code samples for the exercises.
- Supplementary code that we provide for your ease of access.

The repository will be updated weekly. Content from last year's classes is there. Many times it will be the same content however the tutorial content **MIGHT BE UPDATED** before the tutorial.

Github: <https://github.com/Andrian0s/ML4NLP1-2026-Tutorial-Notebooks>

Compute for Exercises

The first exercise is executable locally on CPU

For all further exercises, you will need GPU access:

- Some of you might have a GPU in your laptop (e.g. MacBook M-series)
- Google Colab GPU (T4) for a limited amount of time
- UZH JupyterHub: a course environment with GPU access and shared storage
 - We will provide additional information before the release of Exercise 2

In both Google Colab and JupyterHub, the compute will be limited, so make sure to develop your code locally first and then run it on GPU once you know it works to avoid unnecessary debugging time on the GPU instance!

For Exercise 1 a working local Python setup is enough: Jupyter, scikit-learn and PyTorch. Please install it before the release.

Preliminary Assignment Deadlines (subject to change)

Assignment 01:

Release - 28th September

Submission - 11th October

Peer Review - 19th October

Assignment 02:

Release - 12th October

Submission - 25th October

Peer Review - 2nd November

Assignment 03:

Non practical Assignment handled by Simon. Details to come later but submission date is typically ~20th Jan

Assignment 04:

Release - 2nd November

Submission - 15th November

Peer Review - 23rd November

Assignment 05:

Release - 16th November

Submission - 29th November

Peer Review - 7th December

Assignment 06:

Release - 30th November

Submission - 13th December

Peer Review - 21st December

FAQs:

Q: Can we also work in a pair or be a solo team?

A: We cannot accommodate pairs or solo teams. As part of also your future job, you will have to collaborate so it's good to get acquainted to the situation early. Importantly, we don't have enough compute/grading capacity for everyone to work in pairs/solo teams.

Q: What's the submission format for Assignments?

A: A uniform single file where there is an integrated report as part of the jupyter notebooks.

Further FAQs:

Q: What if I am assigned my own team's submission to review?

A: It should not happen, we check the assignments before the review period opens. If it does, write to us via E-mail @ TAs and we will give you a different one. Please do not review your own team's work.

Q: What happens if we miss the submission deadline?

A: The upload closes automatically at 23:59 and cannot be reopened, so the exercise counts as not submitted. If something serious happens, contact us before the deadline, not after it.

Further FAQs:

Q: Can we use ChatGPT, Copilot or similar tools?

A: Yes, within the rules stated in each exercise, and you have to declare which tools you used and what for. Work that is purely AI-generated, with no sign of your own understanding, loses points.

Q: What if someone in our team stops contributing?

A: Teams stay the same for all exercises, so tell us early via E-mail @ TAs. We can help while the exercise is running; after the deadline there is very little we can do.